

Flexible Working Arrangements Policy

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1. Purpose

Zuqah Technologies recognises that a one-size-fits-all approach to working hours and location does not serve all employees equally well. This policy sets out the flexible working options available, how to request them and how requests are assessed.

2. Default working arrangement

The default working arrangement at Zuqah Technologies is:

Hours	40 hours per week (8 hours per day)
Core hours	10:00 AM – 5:00 PM (IST), Monday to Friday
Location	Hybrid — at least 3 days per week in office for most roles

Core hours are the window when employees are expected to be reachable and available for meetings, regardless of any flexible arrangement.

3. Types of flexible working

3.1 Flexible start and end times

Employees may shift their start and end times outside the default (typically 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM) provided:

- Core hours (10:00 AM – 5:00 PM) are always covered
- Total daily hours remain 8
- The arrangement is agreed with the manager

Example: 7:30 AM – 4:30 PM, or 10:00 AM – 7:00 PM.

3.2 Compressed work week

An employee may work their full weekly hours across 4 days instead of 5, resulting in one day off per week. This requires manager approval and is subject to the team's operational needs.

3.3 Reduced hours (part-time)

An employee may request a reduction in contracted hours (e.g., to 30 or 32 hours per week). This is treated as a contract variation and adjusts salary and benefits pro rata. Approval requires sign-off from the manager and People Operations.

3.4 Additional remote working days

Employees who wish to work more than the default number of remote days may request an arrangement of up to fully remote, subject to role requirements. Roles that are designated "office essential" (e.g., requiring physical presence for lab, reception or client-facing duties) are not eligible for full remote arrangements.

3.5 Shift in working week

Employees may request a variation in their working days — for example, working Tuesday to Saturday instead of Monday to Friday — subject to team and business needs.

4. Who can request

All permanent employees are eligible to request a flexible working arrangement. There is no minimum length of service required, although requests made during the probation period will be considered in light of the employee's ability to complete their onboarding effectively.

Employees returning from maternity, paternity or adoption leave may make a flexible working request under this policy; these requests receive particular consideration.

5. How to request

5.1 Informal arrangement

For minor adjustments (e.g., a 30-minute shift in start time), the employee can agree this informally with their manager without a formal request.

5.2 Formal request

For significant or permanent changes, the employee submits a formal request through the HR portal under My Requests → Flexible Working. The request should include:

- The type of arrangement requested
- The proposed start date
- How the arrangement will affect the employee's work
- How the impact on colleagues and the business will be managed

5.3 Timeline

Step	Timeline
Acknowledge request	Within 3 working days
Meeting to discuss	Within 10 working days
Written decision	Within 5 working days of meeting
Appeal (if declined)	Within 5 working days of decision

6. How requests are assessed

Requests are assessed based on:

- Operational impact: Can the team function effectively with this arrangement?
- Role requirements: Does the role require physical presence or specific hours?
- Precedent: Has a similar arrangement been agreed with others in comparable roles?
- Performance: Is the employee's current performance consistent with the additional trust that flexible arrangements require?

A request may be declined on business grounds. The reason will be stated in writing. Flexible working requests may not be declined on discriminatory grounds (e.g., a request from a mother for reduced hours cannot be declined on the basis that fathers do not make similar requests).

7. Trial period

Where the impact of an arrangement is uncertain, Zuqah Technologies may agree to a 3-month trial before making the arrangement permanent. The trial will be reviewed at the end of the period with a view to making the arrangement permanent if it is working well.

8. Review and withdrawal

Flexible arrangements are subject to periodic review. Either party may request a review with 4 weeks' notice. Where business circumstances change significantly (e.g., a major project requiring full office presence), Zuqah Technologies may vary the arrangement with 4 weeks' notice.

9. Maintaining performance on a flexible arrangement

Flexible working is based on mutual trust. The employee is responsible for:

- Being available during core hours
- Meeting all deadlines and deliverables as they would on a standard arrangement
- Communicating proactively with their manager and team
- Attending all required meetings, adapting their schedule on those days if needed

A flexible arrangement may be withdrawn if performance deteriorates in a way that is connected to the arrangement.

10. Overtime and additional hours

Flexible arrangements do not affect the employee's contracted hours. Working additional hours beyond contracted hours on a flexible arrangement does not automatically attract additional pay unless authorised in advance by the manager as paid overtime.